# RICOTTA, APPLE AND DRIED FRUIT FILLING

## INGREDIENTS

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| **348 g** | Ricotta |
| **57 g** | Smoked ricotta, coarsely grated |
| **64 g** | Granny Smith apple, peeled and finely grated |
| **29 g** | Dried pear, finely chopped |
| **15 g** | Golden raisins, finely chopped |
| **28 g** | Montasio cheese, finely grated |
| **1 orange** | Orange peel, pith removed and finely chopped |
| **1 lemon** | Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped |
| **1/4 tsp** | Cinnamon, freshly ground |
| **1/2 tsp** | Natural cocoa powder |
| **quantity not given** | Salt |
| **quantity not given** | Black pepper |

## METHOD

1. Pass the ricotta through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
2. Add the smoked ricotta, apple, pear, raisins, Montasio, both citrus peels, the cinnamon and the cocoa. Fold everything together until it is evenly mixed.
3. Season with salt and black pepper. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

## NOTES

The mixture sits deliberately between sweet and savory. Apple, dried fruit and cocoa pull one way, the two ricottas, the Montasio and the seasoning pull the other.
Pass the ricotta through a tamis first. That step is what gets the filling smooth enough to pipe through a 1/2-inch tip.
Both peels go in with the pith stripped off, which keeps the citrus aromatic rather than bitter.
Only 1/2 tsp of cocoa goes in. It is a background note against the fruit, not a chocolate flavor.
The mixture is loose and delicate. Pasta filled with it wants a gentle simmer, not a rolling boil.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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